Dynamic SEO Content Variables for Freshness

1. Objective

Enable dynamic placeholders for price, year, and current date across website to keep SEO content more relevant, up to date, and informative for both users and search engines.

- Add a **dynamic price placeholder ($startingprice$)** to the SEO content area on selected pages.
  - When this placeholder is used, the system should automatically fetch and display the lowest priced product from the first page of the relevant PLP. $startingprice$ should refresh when PLP price data updates.

- Add a **dynamic year placeholder ($thisyear$)** to the SEO content, H1, and widget areas on pages.
  - When this placeholder is used, the system should automatically display the current year.

- Add a **dynamic date placeholder ($currentdate$)** to the SEO content area on selected pages.
  - When this placeholder is used, currentdate should be automatically refreshed every 7 days with a timestamp. Time should be randomly generated for each page. We can pick each Monday to update the dates. The page should display a message such as: "Bu sayfa en son 2026-03-24, 16:47 tarihinde güncellenmiştir."
    In HTML, it should be as:
    <p>Bu sayfa en son <time datetime="2026-03-24T16:47">2026-03-24, 16:47</time> tarihinde güncellenmiştir.<
    /p>

This functionality is intended to improve content freshness, support scalability, and reduce the need for manual updates.

2. Scope

- Sitewide
- All the dynamic widget that **uses year or date variables** on desktop and mobile (example: product comparison widget)

3. Impact Areas

- **Improved Content Relevance:**
  Dynamic price injection ("starting from X₺"), dynamic year, and current date placeholders make SEO content more contextually aligned and up to date, which can positively influence CTR, keyword relevance, and user trust.

- **Freshness Signals:**
  Automatically updated year, date, and price values help search engines recognize the content as fresh and regularly updated, which may support better crawl frequency.

- **Keyword Coverage:**
  The presence of dynamic elements such as price, year, and update date in visible content may improve ranking for queries with modifiers such as "fiyat", "2026", "güncel", and other transactional or time sensitive search intents.

- **Content Scalability:**
  Dynamic placeholders allow SEO content to stay up to date without manual edits, enabling scalable content management across many pages.

- **Controlled Exposure:**
  Since placeholders are only added to selected pages by the SEO team, the feature avoids misleading usage or unnecessary dynamic content across the site.

- **CMS Integration:**
  Requires enabling dynamic placeholder variables ($startingprice$, $thisyear$, $currentdate$) in the CMS that fetch and render data dynamically depending on the page context.

- **Caching Considerations:**
  If price or date values are cached, the system must ensure updates propagate correctly and do not display outdated prices or dates.

- **SEO Team Responsibility:**
  The SEO team is responsible for deciding where placeholders are used and must ensure that dynamically fetched values align with the page context and do not mislead users.

- **Monitoring & Validation:**
  Significant price changes (e.g., ≥10%) may trigger alerts (e.g., Slack) for review, ensuring content accuracy and preventing misleading price messaging.

4. Requirements

4.1 Add dynamic variable placeholders ($startingprice$, $thisyear$, $currentdate$) to the SEO content editor in Hydra CMS.

- $startingprice$ variable:
  - When used on a listing page, this variable should fetch the lowest product price from the first page of the related PLP.
  - When the price of any product on the first PLP page changes, the $startingprice$ value used in the SEO content must automatically update to reflect the latest lowest price.
  - If no valid product prices are available, show fallback text ("N/A").
  - The price should inherit the site's currency and price format.
  - The logic must exclude pagination beyond page 1.

- $thisyear$ variable:
  - When used, this variable should automatically display the current year based on the system date.
  - This variable can be used in SEO content, H1, widget areas, and other editable content fields across the site.

- $currentdate$ variable:
  - When used, this variable should automatically refreshed every 3 days using a randomly generated timestamp.

The SEO team will determine where and when to use these variables (manual control only). Widget areas is an exception it should be updated automatically sitewide.

4.2. Slack Notification for Significant Price Changes

When a product price update causes the new lowest price on the PLP to drop by 10% or more compared to the previously cached $startingprice$,
the system must send an automated Slack alert to the designated SEO channel.

The alert should include:
- PLP name and URL
- Old lowest price vs new lowest price
- Percentage change
- Timestamp of change

4.3. Rendering Requirements

- Dynamic placeholders must be rendered server side.
- Values must be visible in page source.
- Dynamic values must be crawlable by search engines.

5. Edge Cases

Case	Description	Expected Behavior / Handling
No products returned on first PLP page	PLP returns an empty product list (out of stock, filtering error, or seasonal unavailability).	$startingprice$ placeholder should render empty or display fallback text (e.g., "N/A"). No "0₺" or misleading number should appear.
Missing valid price field	Some PLP items may have null or missing price fields (e.g., coming soon, discontinued).	Exclude products with invalid price data; return the lowest valid price. If none, fallback to "N/A."
Extremely low or irrelevant price item at the beginning	Outlier product (e.g., accessory, obsolete SKU) distorts the message.	SEO team must review the PLP before activation; no automatic filtering logic. Responsibility explicitly lies with SEO team. For, price updates there will be &10 control.
Price changes after cache refresh	PLP data becomes outdated, showing a previous price.	Rules should ensure $startingprice$ refreshes in sync with PLP. Avoid showing outdated values.
Pagination applied incorrectly	Lowest price is mistakenly fetched from page 2 or beyond.	Always restrict query to first page only; ignore other pagination results.
Multiple placeholders used	$startingprice$ used twice in the same SEO content block.	System should support multiple occurrences within the same block, all resolved with the same lowest price value.
Current date placeholder format issue	Different locale/date formats may cause inconsistent display (e.g., 03/04 /2026 vs 4 March 2026).	$currentdate$ must follow site locale and standardized date format across all pages.

5. Platform

- Desktop, mweb

6. Use Cases

SEO Content:

"2026 yılında iPhone fiyatları $startingprice$ TL'den başlar.
En güncel modeller ve fiyat seçeneklerini inceleyebilirsiniz.
Bu içerik $currentdate$ tarihinde güncellenmiştir."

H1:

2026 iPhone Fiyatları ve Modelleri

Widget Areas:

2026 yılında en çok tercih edilen iPhone 2026 Modelleri

	Apple iPhone 15 128 GB Mavi	Apple iPhone 17 256 GB Sis Mavisi	Apple iPhone 17 256 GB Beyaz	Apple iPhone 15 128 GB Pembe
Fiyat	47.339,00 TL	81.499,00 TL	80.999,00 TL	47.349,00 TL
Değerlendirmeler	4,8 ★★★★★	4,8 ★★★★★	4,8 ★★★★★	4,8 ★★★★★
Satıcı	Hepsiburada	Reeder	NASA İLETİŞİM	Hepsiburada
İşletim Sistemi	iPhone OS	-	-	iPhone OS
Kamera Çözünürlüğü	48 MP + 12 MP	48 MP	48 MP	48 MP + 12 MP
RAM Kapasitesi	6 GB RAM	8 GB RAM	8 GB RAM	6 GB RAM
Pil Gücü	3877 mAh	3692 mAh	3692 mAh	3877 mAh
Renk	Mavi	Mavi	Beyaz	Pembe

Daha fazla özellik göster

7. Validation & Testing

- Confirm $startingprice$ correctly renders the lowest price on PLP page 1.
- Ensure the rendered price is visible to Googlebot and users.
- Confirm content remains crawlable and properly indexed.
- Simulate a price drop ≥10% and verify a Slack notification is triggered with correct payload (PLP URL, old/new prices, timestamp).
- Confirm $thisyear$ correctly renders the current year across all placements (SEO content, H1, widgets).
- Confirm $currentdate$ correctly renders the current date and follows the site's date format.
- Verify that multiple placeholders on the same page render correctly and consistently.
- Test fallback scenarios:
  - No products returned
  - No valid price available
  - Verify cached pages update correctly after price changes, year change (new year), and date updates.
  - Confirm that dynamic values are included in the rendered HTML.

8. Measurement

- Impression increase for keywords related to "fiyatları", "2026", "güncel", "ne kadar" and similar price intent queries.
- Reduction in manual content edits for price and year updates.
- CTR improvement for pages using dynamic price content.
- Ranking improvement for queries including price and year modifiers.
- Reduced content maintenance time for SEO team across large number of pages.

Approval From Line Manager

APPROVED Meets all the discussed requirements, slight edits regarding scope has been made.

Muhammad Salman Sharif

FAQ & Alignment

1. The changes out of Hydra stated as too risky to change by the tech team.

2. We will align on pricing parts.
3. Question: what should be the date, what should be the refresh frequency and what should be the time data?